

NIGERIA — WEEKLY THREAT BRIEF

Nigerian Military Counter-Insurgency Operating Environment

Reporting period: 24 – 31 August 2026 (7 days) | Issued: Monday 31 August 2026. The North East ground pause ended: ISWAP attacked 101 Special Forces Battalion at Kadiya (Kukawa) on the night of 28–29 August and, among the material recovered afterwards, troops found TWO ANTI-AIRCRAFT ROUNDS — the first physical AAA-signature datapoint in this brief's tracking window. The air campaign meanwhile shifted toward logistics, striking a 44-boat concentration at Kangarwa. Outside the theatre, a mutiny in Niamey on 29 August briefly took the military airbase at Diori Hamani. Background from the baseline assessment and earlier issues is not repeated.

1. Bottom Line Up Front

- The base-attack pause ended at Kadiya, Kukawa — and the exploitation recovered two anti-aircraft rounds. This is the week's single most air-relevant item.** At about 22:45 on Friday 28 August, ISWAP attacked troops of 101 Special Forces Battalion (Sector 3 OPHK) near Kadiya village, Kukawa LGA. Ground troops with OPHK air support repelled the assault; the NAF then flew two precision strikes on the withdrawal — the first against ~10 fighters sheltering under trees (all assessed killed), the second against fighters fleeing toward the Tunbuns/Kangarwa axis, coordinated with MNJTF ISR assets (~15 assessed killed, 10 motorcycles destroyed). Exploitation along the withdrawal route at 06:00 on 29 August found one further body: 26 claimed in total. Friendly cost: four soldiers wounded (stable) and one MRAP damaged. Recovered items included 253 rounds of 7.62x54mm PKT, 12 rounds of 7.62mm special — and two anti-aircraft rounds. Two rounds is ammunition, not a system, and the likeliest reading is heavy-machine-gun ammunition carried for ground use. But it is the first AAA-calibre material this brief has seen reported recovered, it sits on the Lake Chad axis where our strike tempo is concentrated, and it should be treated as an indicator to confirm, not a curiosity. Single-chain (Zagazola/military sources).
- The air campaign moved from personnel to logistics: 44 boats sighted at Kangarwa, 12 destroyed.** At 12:55 on 25 August an ISR mission detected 44 ISWAP logistics boats drawn up on the riverbank near Kangarwa, Kukawa LGA, at coordinates given as ~13.266°N 13.657°E. NAF aircraft identified in the report as 'Phantoms' struck first; an armed-reconnaissance platform remained overhead, observed fighters attempting to salvage and load damaged hulls, and re-attacked the cluster. BDA: four killed, 12 boats destroyed. Two things matter operationally. First, 32 hulls were left — this axis will be re-tasked, and the remainder will disperse and move at night. Second, the re-attack-on-salvagers technique is now a repeating pattern, three weeks running: a struck area is not a cold area. Note also that Kadiya is on the same Kukawa axis, three days later.
- Adamawa re-opened: a Boko Haram camp complex destroyed on Kopre Mountain, 21 claimed killed.** Between 01:30 on 26 August and 04:10 on 27 August, Army troops with a tactical team moved by stealth onto a camp in the Kopre Mountain general area of Hong LGA and assaulted it. Reported result: 21 Boko Haram killed, others escaping wounded, the camp and its logistics destroyed along with motorcycles, bicycles and jerrycans of fuel; AK-47s, magazines and 7.62mm special ammunition recovered. One member of the supporting hunter component was killed; no military equipment losses. This is the first substantial Adamawa camp complex reported inside the rolling window and suggests the Hong / Mandara-fringe axis is re-forming as a JAS rear area. Adamawa goes 2 → 3 on the heatmap.
- REGIONAL — a mutiny in Niamey on 29 August struck the military airbase at Diori Hamani, the AES counter-terrorism and drone hub. Multi-source.** Mutinous soldiers attacked the airbase (co-located with Niamey's civilian airport and home to military aircraft, drones and an Alliance of Sahel States counter-terrorism unit), then the state broadcaster and the presidency. The regime and its Russian Africa Corps partners retook the base late on Saturday; Niamey was reported normal by Sunday and the government says the mutiny is contained. For an air unit this is an airspace and coordination item, not just politics: Niger's

southern border is the Lakurawa/ISSP seam, Nigeria–Niger security cooperation has been poor since 2023 and is now worse, and Nigerien airspace management should be treated as unpredictable for the next several weeks. Watch for opportunistic activity on the border while Niamey is looking inward.

- **Force protection otherwise holds, but base attacks ran in BOTH theatres this week, and CASEVAC infrastructure improved.** No enemy drone use, no MANPADS employment, no GPS or EW interference and no aircraft or UAV losses — thirteen weeks, verified again by search this week. But alongside Kadiya, a large force attacked FOB Sifawa barracks and two communities in Bodinga LGA, Sokoto, in daylight on 26 August: repelled, one soldier killed in action, an APC and a Buffalo transport damaged. On the positive side, the COAS commissioned a helipad at 44 Nigerian Army Reference Hospital, Kaduna on 25 August, explicitly to speed air evacuation of wounded soldiers, alongside a new critical care centre — a receiving facility worth reconnoitring before you need it.

2. North East Developments

Window note: a busier week than the last, on the ground and in the air. The base-attack pause that had held since Mandaragirau (15 August) ended at Kadiya on 28–29 August; a village attack at Juhuhi (Hawul) opened the window on 23 August; ISWAP also attacked 212 Battalion at Tungushe in Jere LGA. The air component worked logistics as hard as personnel. The factional war inside the enclaves is now corroborated by official reporting rather than resting on a single chain.

Kadiya, Kukawa — the base attack and the AAA find, 28–29 August

Detail as at Section 1. The sequencing is worth noting for tasking: human intelligence on terrorist movement around Kadiya preceded the attack; the ground repel was air-supported in contact; two follow-on precision strikes worked the withdrawal, the second explicitly coordinated with MNJTF ISR; a ground exploitation team walked the withdrawal route at first light. That is a complete find-fix-finish-exploit cycle in under eight hours, and it is the exploitation phase that produced the anti-aircraft rounds. If your unit can get sight of the actual calibre through the ground chain — 12.7mm and 14.5mm imply a heavy MG or ZPU role; 23mm would imply something materially worse — that single data point is worth chasing.

Kangarwa boat strike and the logistics campaign, 25 August

Detail as at Section 1. Lake Chad waterways move personnel, weapons, food and fuel between ISWAP locations, so a 44-boat concentration is a high-value, fixed, observable target set — and one that regenerates. Related counter-logistics activity in the window: troops of 159 Battalion arrested three suspected ISWAP logistics suppliers during a curfew operation in Geidam, Yobe, who had allegedly been buying petroleum products and other supplies for fighters on the Gorom–Damasak axis (₦185,950, two phones and an ID card recovered); 11 suspects were picked up in Monguno LGA (eight collaborators, two couriers or spies, one fighter); and a suspected ISWAP operative was arrested at Mairari, Guzamala LGA with an image of armed men on him.

Continuing strike tempo and contacts

- **Sambisa precision strike — reported 30/31 August.** The OPHK air component struck a terrorist enclave in the Sambisa axis after sighting three fighters entering a structure and a fourth parking a motorcycle nearby; the strike destroyed the building and the motorcycle and killed four (official OPHK operational report via NAN/P.M. News). Sambisa coverage is therefore continuous alongside the Lake Chad work.
- **Infiltration and contact.** Troops of the 81 Division Task Force Battalion under OPHK foiled an ISWAP infiltration attempt and killed four (reported 27 August). ISWAP attacked 212 Battalion at Tungushe, Jere LGA — repelled. 115 Task Force Battalion with the CJTF made contact with

ISWAP at Rumirigo, Askira-Uba LGA; the fighters fled leaving a pistol and seven rounds of 9mm.

- **MSR IEDs continue.** Troops discovered a detonated IED on the Dikwa–Marte road on about 25 August following a reported explosion on the route. That keeps the Dikwa/Marte/Ajiri road complex as the standing IED belt — the fifth device or device area reported there inside a fortnight. Bridge and junction approaches remain the predictable emplacement points.

Factional war now corroborated in official reporting

A suspected female ISWAP member surrendered with her two children at Mafa; the official OPHK report states she fled the Burari enclave with them 'following violent clashes between rival terrorist factions.' Until now the ISWAP–JAS factional fighting thread has rested almost entirely on Zagazola security-source reporting. An official operational report attributing a surrender to factional violence is the first independent-of-that-chain corroboration this brief has recorded. Two internally displaced minors from Chikide in the Mandara Mountains were also intercepted on the Wala–Gwoza–Pulka road on 29 August. Troops conducted wet-season clearance patrols across Yobe communities through the window.

Schools thread — roughly day 108 and day 63, still unresolved

No release, negotiation or proof-of-life reporting surfaced in this window for the 42 Mussa pupils (taken 15 May) or the 36 Lassa students and one staff member (taken 29 June) — 78 children and one teacher in total. Senator Ali Ndume publicly pressed the Army to redouble efforts on 22 August, following the Uba parents' protest reported last week. Nothing has changed since.

3. Air / ISR & Force-Protection Watch Items

- **Treat the Kadiya anti-aircraft rounds as an indicator to confirm, not an alarm — and not a nothing.** Two rounds recovered on a battlefield is weak evidence of an air-defence capability and reasonable evidence that AAA-calibre ammunition is circulating on the Lake Chad axis. Revise the standing assumption from 'no AAA signature at all' to 'no AAA employment observed; AAA-calibre ammunition present in the Kukawa area.' Practical actions: seek the calibre through the ground chain; brief crews transiting the Kukawa / Kangarwa / Tunbuns axis on it; and treat any subsequent recovery, or the first report of tracer or airburst, as a priority report rather than a routine one.
- **Logistics-boat interdiction is now a recurring ISR task with a specific signature.** The Kangarwa engagement began as an ISR sighting of hulls drawn up at a fixed riverbank point and ended with a fighting aircraft re-attacking salvagers. Expect repeat tasking on the same axis, dispersal and night movement of the surviving 32 hulls, and value in riverbank pattern-of-life rather than one-off searches. Also note the deconfliction implication: the Kukawa follow-on strike was coordinated with MNJTF ISR — coalition assets, not only NAF-internal ones, are cueing over the Lake Chad approaches.
- **Multi-axis, multi-strike work continues; assume struck areas are re-attacked.** Inside eight days the air component worked Kangarwa (25 Aug), Sambisa (30 Aug) and Kadiya's withdrawal route in two separate strikes (28–29 Aug). Verify ROZ activation, altitude blocks and the strike-clearance chain over the Kukawa/Lake Chad approaches, the Sambisa enclave belt and the Biu/Hawul axis before every launch, and do not assume a target area is cold minutes after a strike.
- **Regional airspace: the Niamey mutiny degrades an already poor picture on the northern border.** Diori Hamani hosts Nigerien military aircraft and drones, an AES counter-terrorism unit and Russian Africa Corps personnel, and was contested for the better part of a day on 29 August. Even with the base retaken, assume unpredictable Nigerien airspace management, possible short-notice closures or NOTAM activity, and heightened border sensitivity for several

weeks. Nigeria–Niger intelligence sharing has been blocked since the 2023 coup — this makes any cross-border deconfliction harder, not easier, precisely while Lakurawa sits on that seam.

- **CASEVAC: 44 NARH Kaduna now has a commissioned helipad.** The COAS commissioned the pad on 25 August at the 44 Nigerian Army Reference Hospital, Kaduna, explicitly to speed emergency evacuation of wounded soldiers, alongside the new Waidi Shaibu Critical Care Centre at the same site. If you fly casualties out of the North West, this materially changes the receiving picture. Confirm pad dimensions, approach and departure lanes, lighting and the control arrangement before you need them rather than on the night.
- **Base attacks are running in both theatres in the same week — and the North West one was in daylight.** Sifawa (Bodinga LGA, Sokoto) was hit at 09:20 on 26 August by a large force attacking the barracks and the Badau and Danchadi communities simultaneously. Troops of 28 Special Forces Brigade from FOB Sifawa with FOB Shagari, the 8 Division Strike Team and a Mobile Strike Team repelled it; one soldier was killed, an APC lost two tyres and a Buffalo transport had its fuel tank and mirrors destroyed. Daylight, multi-pronged, against a barracks: if tasked into the North West, do not assume the threat picture there is materially softer than the North East's.
- **Threat systems: nothing employed — thirteen weeks.** No enemy drone use, no MANPADS, no GPS or EW interference, no aircraft or UAV losses. The last documented armed-drone use against a Nigerian base remains Sabon Gari, Damboa (late January 2026); the last confirmed airframe loss remains the 2 January CH-4 (technical failure, Kontagora). Searches this week returned no new Nigerian air loss. The standing caution stands and the Kadiya AAA find sharpens it: ISWAP's incentive to answer strike losses with unmanned systems or with air defence is rising alongside our tempo.
- **US dimension — no new activity; posture assumption unchanged.** No new AFRICOM announcements concerning Nigeria this window. The standing picture is the December 2025 Bauni Forest strikes against Lakurawa in Sokoto and the May 2026 coordinated strikes against ISIS in the North East; ISS assesses that sporadic strikes alone have not degraded Lakurawa, which is now operating from Borgu. US kinetic activity remains dormant, US ISR presence remains possible — keep it in the deconfliction picture.
- **Information integrity: no fabricated-loss campaign this week, but the fabrication tempo continues.** PRNigeria debunked a viral video falsely portraying visitors to a Nigerian senator as bandit kingpins (29 August). Together with last week's AI-generated obituaries targeting the COAS and the earlier DHQ account-breach warning, the rule is unchanged: treat any loss, shoot-down or casualty claim involving air assets as unverified until confirmed through the chain.

4. Other Theatres in Brief

- **North West — a barracks attack, and IEDs that are now killing civilians.** Beyond Sifawa (Section 3): Sector 2 Op FANSAN YAMMA troops killed several terrorists and recovered arms, motorcycles and rustled livestock in Rabah LGA, Sokoto (27–28 August). In Zamfara an IED on the Gurusu–Gwashi road in Bukkuyum LGA killed two civilians at 08:04 on 26 August, and a second device on the same road was recovered and safely destroyed the following day — North West IED emplacement has moved from targeting troops to killing rural road users, and Zagazola ran a standalone analysis on the widening civilian IED threat. Also: two suspected terrorists arrested with an AK-47, ammunition and communication equipment at FOB Kaura Namoda (25 August); Fansan Yamma arrested three collaborators and destroyed enclaves in Kaduna and Katsina (29 August); a ransom exchange was foiled and a kidnapped woman rescued in Danko-Wasagu, Kebbi; 1 Division troops recovered 97 rustled livestock in Gwarzo, Kano; and bandit leader Kachalla Namadi was killed by rival gunmen in Zamfara. The NFIU

reported terrorist financiers moving funds through women's bank accounts and crowdfunding (25 August).

- **North Central / Middle Belt — very high volume, comparatively low lethality; the reciprocal cycle is now largely about cattle and farmland.** Plateau produced a stream of OPEP items in both directions. Against communities: a woman killed in an ambush at Batok 2, Riyom (28 August); a body recovered at Bachi, Fang District, Riyom; three killed at Gwarim near Riyom while an attack on Rim was foiled (26–27 August); a motorcyclist killed on the Matelem–Ndung road, Tangur District, Bokkos; two passengers abducted after gunmen blocked the Bokkos–Barkin Ladi road (28 August); a man abducted at Angwan Kaji, Bassa. Against herders: Berom militia killed 21 cows in a targeted attack in Riyom, and two further rustling attempts were foiled with 19 and five cattle recovered. Troops also foiled armed Fulani attacks at Manja Village and Manja Forest in Mangu, foiled a kidnapping in Jos North at 03:45 rescuing two, and arrested herders over farmland destruction and militia over a cattle attack at Pankshin. The GOC 3 Division and Comd OPEP engaged Irigwe farmers and stakeholders in Bassa over attacks and farm destruction. In Benue, Operation Zenda drew public criticism after a clearance operation around Ayilamo, Logo LGA reportedly killed some 200 cattle — a civil-military friction item to watch. In Niger State, Op SAVANNAH SHIELD foiled a kidnapping of farmers at Tudun Harara, Mariga LGA (26 August). In Kaduna's Jema'a LGA a farmer–herder clash at Rafin Dadi killed one, and troops averted a protest over farm destruction at Fido.
- **South East — quiet after the August flare.** No new IPOB/ESN camp raids or IED incidents were reported in this window following the 15 and 22 August Anambra operations. Anambra holds 3 on the heatmap; with the November governorship approaching, expect tempo to rise again rather than settle.
- **Niger Delta / Gulf of Guinea — twelfth consecutive quiet week for militancy; enforcement heavy.** No new pipeline or maritime attack claims. 6 Division troops found refining equipment and 3,120 litres of stolen crude in the Okarki Forest, Ahoada West LGA (Rivers); 343 Artillery Regiment intercepted tugboats and barges carrying 21,000 bags of illegally mined ilmenite 'black sand' in Bayelsa, and Op DELTA SANITY intercepted a further 10,400 bags with five arrests; two suspects were arrested over illegal petroleum products in Rivers.
- **Regional and political weather — Niamey dominates; JNIM keeps the Sahel pressure on.** Beyond the mutiny (Section 1): JNIM ambushed Malian Armed Forces and Russian Africa Corps personnel near Erintedjeft in the Tombouctou region on about 28 August, killing at least 19 — the Sahel dynamic that feeds Lakurawa reinforcement into the Nigeria–Niger–Benin tri-border. Domestically, the DSS instructed counsel to seek adjournment of its cyber-bullying case against Omoyele Sowore until after the 2027 presidential election (30 August), and the Inspector-General of Police ordered a nationwide crackdown on mob killings (24 August) after a run of jungle-justice incidents. No gubernatorial changes this week.

5. Country Activity Heatmap (last 3 months)

The two views below summarise assessed security activity across all 36 states and the FCT over roughly the last three months (≈ early June – 31 August 2026). The choropleth shows each state's dominant incident type (fill colour) and intensity (shade depth and number); the matrix breaks activity down by incident type. This is an indicative qualitative assessment for orientation — synthesised from open-source reporting, not a counted event dataset such as ACLED. ONE level change this issue: Adamawa 2 → 3, dominant type unchanged at terrorism, on the destruction of the Kopre Mountain camp complex in Hong LGA (26–27 August, 21 claimed killed) — the first substantial Adamawa camp reported inside the window and an indication that the Hong / Mandara-fringe axis is re-forming as a JAS rear area. Everything else holds. Borno holds 4 but is heavily reinforced (Kadiya base attack and the anti-aircraft rounds, the Kangarwa boat strike, Hawul and Tungushe attacks, the Dikwa–Marte IED). Sokoto holds 4, reinforced by the daylight Sifawa

barracks attack and a soldier killed in action. Zamfara holds 4 and gains a new IED marker rather than a level change — the Gurusu–Gwashi road device killed two civilians and a second was recovered on the same road. Niger holds 4 with no follow-on Lakurawa mass event after Borgu; Plateau holds 4 on high-volume, lower-lethality activity; Katsina, Benue hold 4; Kaduna, Kebbi, Kogi, Anambra hold 3; Kwara, Yobe hold 2; Delta holds 2 on a twelfth quiet militancy week; Jigawa and Osun hold 1.

Nigeria Activity Heatmap — Geographic View (assessed, last ~3 months)
Indicative qualitative assessment as of 2026-08-31 — not a counted incident dataset

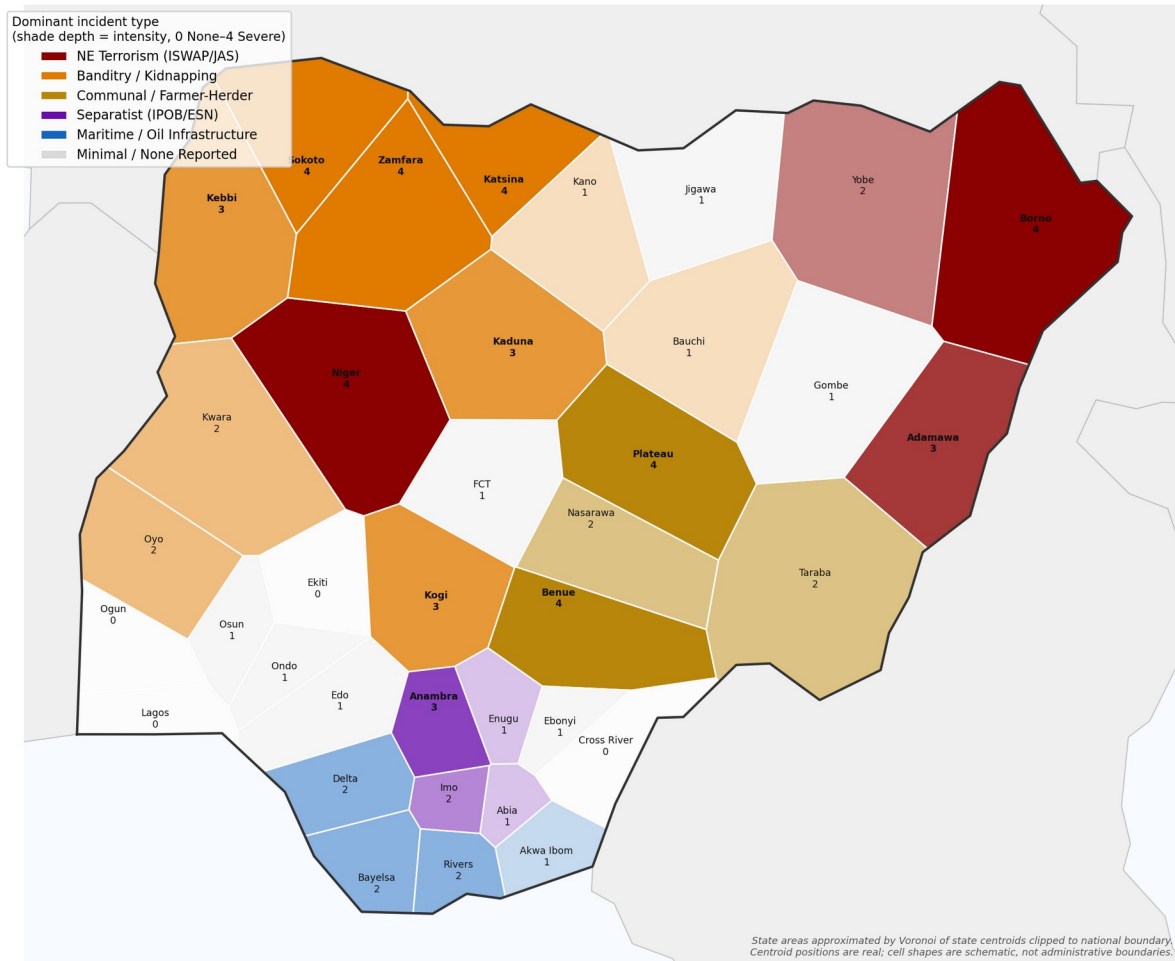


Figure 1 — Activity choropleth on a Natural Earth basemap (Nigeria + neighbours). Fill = dominant incident type; shade depth & number = intensity (0 None–4 Severe). State areas are approximated by Voronoi of state centroids clipped to the national boundary — centroid positions are real, cell shapes schematic. Indicative qualitative assessment, not a counted dataset.

Nigeria Activity Heatmap — Incident Type by State (assessed, last ~3 months)
States grouped by geopolitical zone — indicative qualitative assessment as of 2026-08-31, not a counted dataset

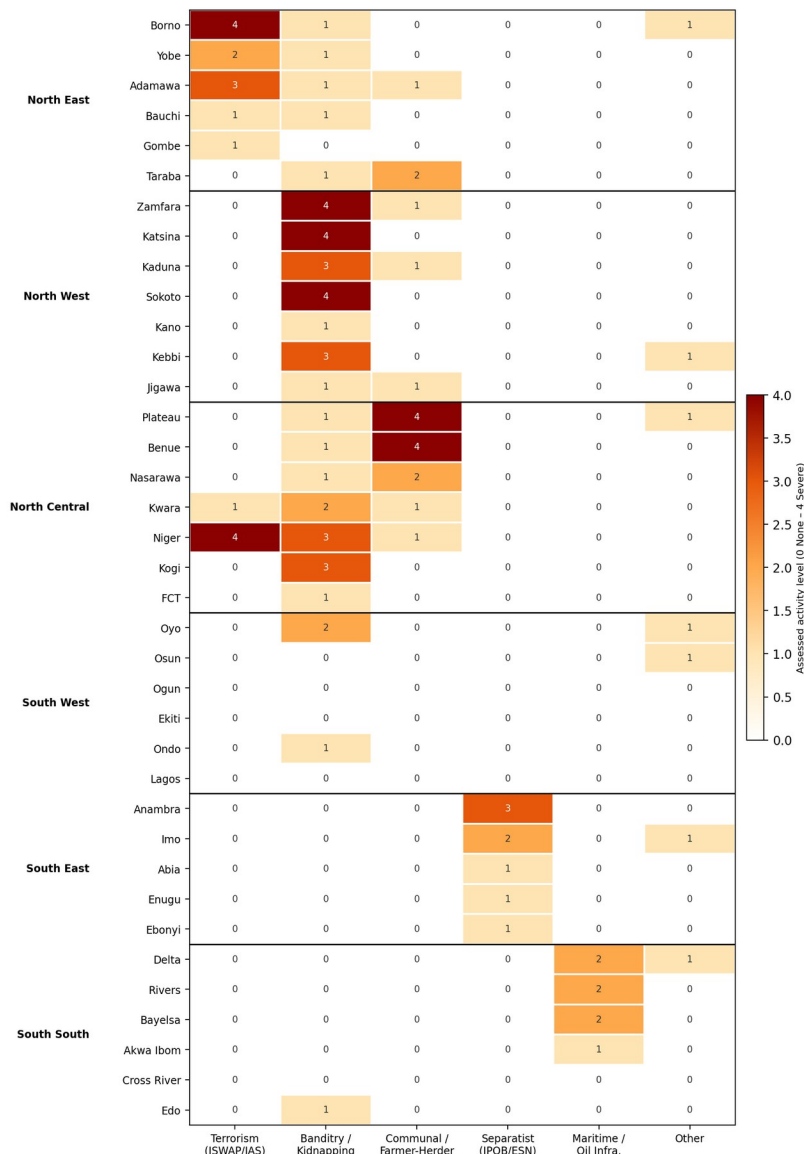


Figure 2 — Incident type by state (states grouped by geopolitical zone). Cell value/shade = assessed activity level, 0 None–4 Severe. Indicative qualitative assessment, not a counted dataset.

6. Events Map — UCDP (curated) & GDELT (news-derived)

Two-panel figure from this morning's scheduled daily map run (31 August; GDELT ingested through 30 August). LEFT PANEL: no new UCDP release landed this week, so the most recent seven days of curated data remain 25–31 July 2026 (29 events, ~174 best-estimate fatalities, 57 civilian) — meaning the lag has widened back out to roughly four and a half weeks. Read the left panel as verified late-July pattern, not as this week's ground truth. RIGHT PANEL: news-derived GDELT events for the actual last seven days (24–30 August 2026: 420 machine-coded events from ~3,718 articles, deduplicated and cross-checked against UCDP) — down slightly on last week's 447. GDELT is timely but noisy: locations and event types are machine-extracted and individual dots are not verified incidents. Cross-referenced against Sections 1–4, expect clusters over the Kukawa/Kangarwa and Lake Chad approaches (Kadiya, the boat strike), the Sambisa belt, Hong LGA in Adamawa (Kopre Mountain), Bodinga in Sokoto (Sifawa), Bukkuyum in Zamfara (the road IEDs) and a dense, diffuse Plateau signature across Riyom, Bokkos and Mangu. Read the panels together: UCDP for verified pattern, GDELT for current tempo and geography.

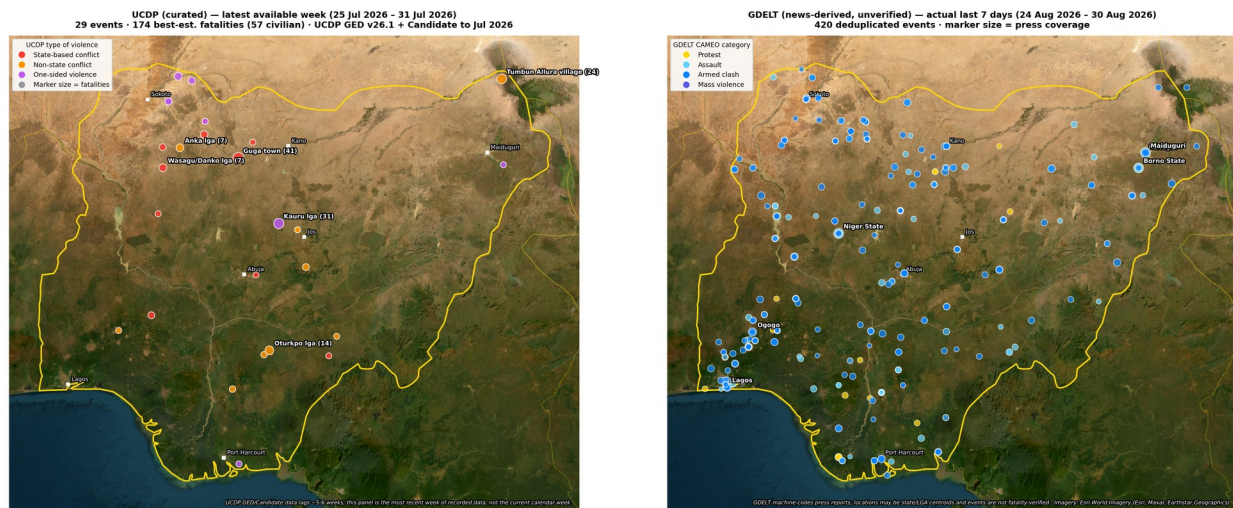


Figure 3 — Left: UCDP-recorded conflict events, most recent 7 days of available curated data (25–31 July 2026; lags ~4½ weeks — NOT current-week ground truth). Right: GDELT news-derived events for 24–30 August 2026 — machine-coded from press reporting, deduplicated, unverified; indicative of current reporting tempo only. Rendered 31 August 2026 from the daily-updated Nigeria Events Map.

Interactive map: <https://rbmglobal.co.uk/nigeria-activity-map/>

7. Sources

Open-source reporting consulted 31 August 2026. Military and government figures are flagged as claims throughout. Two-source or better this window: the Niamey mutiny and the recapture of the Diori Hamani airbase (Al Jazeera, Reuters via Yahoo/TimesLIVE, NBC News, Asharq Al-Awsat — independent chains), the unresolved Mussa/Lassa school abductions (Reuters via US News/TimesLIVE, ThisDay, Sahara Reporters), and the OPHK 24-hour operational report (official, NAN via P.M. News). Effectively single-chain (Zagazola security-sources or military sources) and unverified: the Kadiya/Kukawa engagement including the 26 claimed killed and the two anti-aircraft rounds, the Kangarwa boat strike and its BDA, the Kopre Mountain camp raid and its 21 claimed killed, the Sifawa barracks attack, and most Plateau, Zamfara and Kaduna minor items. The anti-aircraft rounds in particular rest on one report and should be confirmed through your own chain before being briefed as fact. Date-verification note: three recirculated items surfaced in searches and were excluded as not current — the January 2026 CH-4 loss near Kontagora (returned by an August-2026 aircraft-loss query), the December 2025 US Bauni Forest strikes and the May 2026 US coordinated strikes (both returned by an August-2026 AFRICOM query), and the ISS Lakurawa assessment (published 2 February 2026, cited here as standing background only, not as current-week reporting).

North East & air campaign

- [Troops repel terrorist attack in Kukawa, neutralise 26, destroy 10 motorcycles \(29 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Kadiya, 28–29 Aug; 101 SF Bn; two NAF strikes; MNJTF ISR; 4 soldiers wounded, MRAP damaged; TWO ANTI-AIRCRAFT ROUNDS recovered)
- [Operation Hadin Kai airstrikes neutralise four ISWAP terrorists, destroy 12 boats in Borno \(26 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Kangarwa, 25 Aug 12:55; 44 boats sighted; 'Phantoms' then armed-recce re-attack on salvagers)
- [Troops kill 21 Boko Haram terrorists, destroy camp in Adamawa \(27 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Kopre Mountain, Hong LGA, 26–27 Aug; camp and logistics destroyed; one hunter killed)
- [Troops intensify crackdown on ISWAP, nab 15 suspects, kill scores \(31 Aug 2026\)](#) — NAN via P.M. News (official OPHK 24-hour report: Sambisa strike 4 killed; Monguno 11 arrests; Geidam logistics suppliers; Tungushe and Rumirigo contacts; Mafa surrender attributed to factional clashes)

- [Troops Repel Suspected ISWAP Attack on Hawul Community \(24 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Juhuhi village, 23 Aug 18:45; resident wounded by stray round; troops, police, CJTF and hunters responded)
- [Troops foil ISWAP infiltration attempt, kill four terrorists in Borno \(27 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (81 Division Task Force Battalion under OPHK)
- [Troops discover detonated IED along Dikwa–Marte road in Borno \(26 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (standing MSR IED belt)
- [Troops arrest suspected ISWAP member, recover image of armed men in Borno \(26 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Mairari, Guzamala LGA; OPHK with CJTF)
- [Troops conduct wet-season clearance patrols across communities in Yobe \(26 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola
- [Ndume To Military: Rescue 78 School Children Abducted By Bandits in Two Borno Communities \(22 Aug 2026\)](#) — ThisDay (Mussa 15 May and Lassa 29 Jun cohorts; 78 children and one teacher still held)

Air, CASEVAC & force protection

- [COAS Commissions Helipad To Boost Emergency Evacuation of Wounded Soldiers in Kaduna \(25 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (44 Nigerian Army Reference Hospital, Kaduna)
- [COAS Commissions critical care centre, strengthens combat medical support in Kaduna \(25 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Waidi Shaibu Critical Care Centre, 44 NARH)
- [Nigeria loses CH-4 drone \(Jan 2026 — standing reference, NOT current\)](#) — Military Africa (last confirmed airframe loss: NAF-114, propulsion failure near Kontagora, 2 Jan 2026)
- [Viral Video Claiming Bandit Kingpins Visited Nigerian Senator Found to Be False \(29 Aug 2026\)](#) — PRNigeria investigation via Zagazola (continuing fabrication tempo)
- [U.S. Africa Command press releases \(standing reference\)](#) — AFRICOM (no new Nigeria strike announcements in window)

Regional — Niger, Sahel

- [Niger's military-led government says it contained mutiny: What next? \(30 Aug 2026\)](#) — Al Jazeera (29 Aug mutiny; Diori Hamani airbase, state broadcaster, presidency)
- [Niger regains control of airbase after soldiers mutiny \(31 Aug 2026\)](#) — Reuters via TimesLIVE (airbase houses military aircraft, drones and an AES counter-terrorism unit; Africa Corps involved in retaking it)
- [Mutinous soldiers attack airport, presidency in Niger capital \(29–30 Aug 2026\)](#) — NBC News (independent chain)
- [JNIM ambush kills 19 Malian, Russian troops in Tombouctou \(28 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Erintedjeft area; Sahel pressure feeding the tri-border)
- [Lakurawa: Nigeria's hybrid threat that attracted US missile fire \(2 Feb 2026 — standing background\)](#) — ISS Africa (Lakurawa operational leadership now assessed to be based in Borgu; ~2,000 members; Dec 2025 US Bauni Forest strikes)

North West

- [Troops repel terrorists' attacks on Sifawa barracks, communities in Sokoto \(27 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Bodinga LGA, 26 Aug 09:20; 28 SF Bde; one soldier KIA; APC and Buffalo damaged)
- [IED explosion kills two civilians along Gurusu–Gwashi road in Zamfara \(27 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Bukkuyum LGA, 26 Aug 08:04)
- [Troops recover, safely dispose of terrorist-planted IED in Zamfara \(27 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (second device, same Gurusu–Gwashi road)

- [Operation Fansan Yamma troops arrest terrorist collaborators, destroy enclaves in Kaduna, Katsina \(29 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (JTF North West)
- [Troops neutralise terrorists, recover weapons, motorcycles in Sokoto \(28 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Sector 2 OPFY, Rabah LGA)
- [NFIU Uncovers Terrorist Financing Through Women's Accounts, Crowdfunding \(25 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (counter-finance thread)

Middle Belt

- [Fulani Bandits ambush, kill woman in Riyom community, Plateau \(29 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Batok 2 Village, 28 Aug 21:00)
- [Gunmen block Bokkos–Barkin Ladi road, abduct two passengers in Plateau \(29 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (28 Aug ~20:40)
- [Troops foil attack on Rim community, three killed in Gwarim, Plateau \(27 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Riyom LGA)
- [Berom militia allegedly kill 21 cows in targeted attack in Riyom, Plateau \(26 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (reciprocal-cycle evidence)
- [Operation Zenda accused of triggering tension after killing 200 cattle in Benue clearance operation \(27 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Ayilamo, Logo LGA; civil-military friction)
- [Operation Savannah Shield troops foil attempted kidnapping of farmers in Niger \(27 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Tudun Harara, Mariga LGA)
- [Farmer-Herder Clash Claims One Life in Kaduna Community \(26 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (Rafin Dadi, Kaninkon, Jema'a LGA)

South South & national

- [Troops discover illegal crude oil refining materials in Rivers forest \(27 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (6 Division; Okarki Forest, Ahoada West; 3,120 litres)
- [Troops arrest 10 suspected illegal miners, seize 21,000 bags of black sand in Bayelsa \(27 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola (343 Artillery Regiment)
- [Jungle Justice Is Murder, Not Justice — IGP Disu Orders Nationwide Crackdown on Mob Killings \(24 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola
- [DSS Directs Counsel to Seek Adjournment in Sowore's Alleged Cybercrime Case Until After 2027 Presidential Election \(30 Aug 2026\)](#) — Zagazola

Annex A — State Governors, Ethnic Affiliation & Principal Army Formations

Standing annex — changes since the 24 August issue are summarised here. NO GUBERNATORIAL CHANGE and NO NEW GOC APPOINTMENTS this issue: the July 2026 slate (Maj Gen Yakubu Yahaya, 9 Div Ilorin; Maj Gen C. R. Nnebeife, 10 Div Jalingo; Maj Gen Moses Gara, 5 Div Makurdi; Maj Gen Auwalu Mahmuda, 2 Div Ibadan) stands, and searches this week returned no further appointments, defections or operation re-designations. FOUR FORMATION-COLUMN UPDATES, all additive: (1) Edo — CORRECTION: HQ 83 Division (Benin City) is added. It was one of the four divisions established in the July 2026 force expansion and was omitted from earlier issues of this annex, which listed only 4 Brigade. (2) Sokoto — 28 Special Forces Brigade with FOB Sifawa and FOB Shagari and the 8 Division Strike Team are named, having repelled the 26 August barracks attack. (3) Borno — 101 Special Forces Battalion (Sector 3, Kukawa axis) and 212 Battalion (Jere) are named from this week's engagements, and MNJTF ISR coordination on the Lake Chad approaches is flagged. (4) Kaduna — the 44 Nigerian Army Reference Hospital entry now records the commissioned helipad and the Waidi Shaibu Critical Care Centre (25 August),

which matter for CASEVAC planning. An Adamawa WATCH marker is added for the Hong / Kopre Mountain axis. The July 2026 force-structure changes remain in transition — expect continuing ambiguity over which headquarters owns a given ground picture or airspace request in the Middle Belt and North Central. Caveats unchanged: ethnic affiliations are as commonly stated in public reporting — several are contested or simplified, and 'Hausa/Fulani' reflects the common compound identification in the far north. Military entries are an indicative open-source ORBAT (division and brigade home locations and operation AORs), not a current disposition — task-force deployments move constantly; verify against your unit's own theatre picture.

State	Governor	Party (changes)	Ethnic affiliation (as publicly reported)	Principal Army formation(s) in state (indicative)
NORTH EAST				
Borno	Babagana Umara Zulum	APC	Kanuri	HQ 7 Div & OPHK Theatre Comd (Maiduguri); OPHK Sector 3 (Kukawa) incl. 101 Special Forces Bn; 212 Bn (Jere); 115 Task Force Bn (Askira-Uba); 81 Div Task Force Bn attached; task-force bdes on the Monguno/Dikwa/Gwoza/Bama axes; MNJTF Sector 3 (Baga) — MNJTF ISR now cueing strikes on the Lake Chad approaches; NAF air component OPHK (Maiduguri)
Yobe	Mai Mala Buni	APC	Kanuri	OPHK Sector 2 (Damaturu); task-force brigade elements (Buni Yadi axis)
Adamawa	Ahmadu Umaru Fintiri	APC (defected from PDP, Feb 2026)	Northern-Adamawa minority (Madagali axis); identification varies in public reporting	23 Bde (Yola) — WATCH: Boko Haram camp complex destroyed on Kopre Mountain, Hong LGA, 26–27 Aug; Hong / Mandara-fringe axis re-forming as a JAS rear area
Bauchi	Bala Mohammed	PDP (opposition)	Fulani	33 Artillery Bde (Shadawanka Barracks, Bauchi)
Gombe	Muhammadu Inuwa Yahaya	APC	Fulani	Rear-area/support elements to OPHK
Taraba	Agbu Kefas	APC (defection from PDP announced for Jan 2026)	Jukun	HQ 10 Div (Jalingo) — activated Jul 2026, GOC Maj Gen C. R. Nnebeife; 6 Bde (Jalingo); Op Whirl Stroke elements
NORTH WEST				
Kaduna	Uba Sani	APC	Hausa/Fulani	HQ 1 Div (Kaduna); Nigerian Defence Academy; major NAF bases (Kaduna); 44 Nigerian Army Reference Hospital — NEW: helipad and Waidi Shaibu Critical Care Centre commissioned 25 Aug 2026 for air CASEVAC of wounded
Kano	Abba Kabir Yusuf	APC (defected from NNPP, 26 Jan 2026)	Hausa/Fulani	3 Bde (Kano)
Katsina	Dikko Umaru Radda	APC	Fulani	17 Bde (Katsina) — Op Fansan Yamma
Kebbi	Nasir Idris	APC	Fulani (Kauran Gwandu)	Elements under 8 Div

State	Governor	Party (changes)	Ethnic affiliation (as publicly reported)	Principal Army formation(s) in state (indicative)
				AOR (Birnin Kebbi garrison)
Sokoto	Ahmed Aliyu	APC	Hausa/Fulani	HQ 8 Div (Sokoto) — Op Fansan Yamma; 28 Special Forces Bde (FOB Sifawa, FOB Shagari); 8 Div Strike Team — repelled the 26 Aug Sifawa barracks attack
Zamfara	Dauda Lawal	APC (defected from PDP, Mar 2026)	Hausa	1 Bde (Gusau); OPFY Sector 2
Jigawa	Umar Namadi	APC	Hausa/Fulani	Elements under 3 Bde (Kano) AOR
NORTH CENTRAL				
Plateau	Caleb Mutfwang	APC (defected from PDP, late 2025)	Mwaghavul	HQ 3 Armoured Div (Jos); UPDATED: Op ENDURING PEACE (OPEP) — Comd Maj Gen W. M. Dangana; reporting now consistently uses OPEP for the Plateau AOR (vice Op Safe Haven); state-level Op Rainbow alongside
Benue	Hyacinth Alia	APC	Tiv	HQ 5 Div (Makurdi) — GOC Maj Gen Moses Gara, dual-hatted Comd Op Whirl Stroke (Jul 2026); 11 Bde (Gboko); 72 Special Forces Bn (Makurdi); Operation Zenda (state-level, criticised over the Ayilamo clearance 27 Aug); NAF Tactical Air Command HQ (Makurdi)
Niger	Mohammed Umaru Bago	APC	Nupe	31 Artillery Bde (Minna); Army TRADOC (Minna); 29 Bde (Kainji) — WATCH: Lakurawa operational leadership assessed by ISS to be based in Borgu LGA; Op Savannah Shield active in Mariga LGA this week
Kwara	AbdulRahman AbdulRazaq	APC	Yoruba (Ilorin)	HQ 9 Div (Ilorin) — GOC Maj Gen Yakubu Yahaya, dual-hatted Comd Op Savannah Shield (Jul 2026); Sobi Barracks garrison
Kogi	Ahmed Usman Ododo	APC	Ebira	Garrison elements (Lokoja); confluence-axis security ops; joint ops under 2 Div AOR (western Kogi)
Nasarawa	Abdullahi Sule	APC	Hausa	10 Bde (Lafia); Op Whirl Stroke elements (Lafia axis)
FCT Abuja	— (administered by FCT Minister Nyesom Wike)	APC-aligned (Wike ex-PDP)	Ikwerre (minister)	Guards Bde (Abuja); Defence HQ & Service HQs; NAF HQ
SOUTH EAST				
Abia	Alex Otti	Labour Party (opposition)	Igbo	14 Bde (Ohafia)
Anambra	Charles Soludo (re-elected Nov 2025)	APGA (opposition, APC-aligned)	Igbo	302 Artillery Regt (Onitsha); 15 Bde — established Jul 2026

State	Governor	Party (changes)	Ethnic affiliation (as publicly reported)	Principal Army formation(s) in state (indicative)
				under JTF South East / Op UDO KA; led the 15 and 22 Aug Anambra camp raids
Ebonyi	Francis Nwifuru	APC	Igbo	Elements under 82 Div AOR (Abakaliki)
Enugu	Peter Mbah	APC (defected from PDP)	Igbo	HQ 82 Composite Div (Enugu)
Imo	Hope Uzodinma	APC	Igbo	34 Artillery Bde (Obinze, Owerri)
SOUTH SOUTH				
Rivers	Siminalayi Fubara (reinstated Sep 2025 after emergency rule)	APC (reported defection from PDP, Dec 2025)	Ijaw (Opobo/Nkoro)	HQ 6 Div (Port Harcourt); JTF Op Delta Safe; NNS Pathfinder
Bayelsa	Douye Diri	APC (defected from PDP, 2025)	Ijaw	16 Bde (Yenagoa)
Delta	Sheriff Oborevwori	APC (defected from PDP, May 2025)	Okpe (Urhobo)	63 Bde (Asaba); Op Delta Safe elements
Edo	Monday Okpebholo (elected Sep 2024)	APC	Esan	CORRECTION: HQ 83 Div (Benin City) — established Jul 2026 in the force expansion, omitted from earlier issues of this annex; 4 Bde (Benin City)
Akwa Ibom	Umo Eno	APC (defected from PDP, 2025)	Ibibio	2 Bde (Uyo)
Cross River	Bassey Otu	APC	Efik	13 Bde (Calabar); Navy Eastern Command (Calabar) — anti-piracy / oil-theft offensive announced 21 Aug 2026, continuing
SOUTH WEST				
Lagos	Babajide Sanwo-Olu	APC	Yoruba	HQ 81 Div (Lagos); Navy Western Command
Ogun	Dapo Abiodun	APC	Yoruba	Elements under 81 Div AOR
Oyo	Seyi Makinde	PDP (opposition)	Yoruba	HQ 2 Div (Ibadan) — GOC Maj Gen Auwalu Mahmuda (Jul 2026)
Osun	Ademola Adeleke (re-elected 15 Aug 2026 — second term)	Accord Party — left PDP Dec 2025; re-elected 15 Aug 2026 with 511,067 votes vs APC 444,815; an APC-defection rumour was denied by his camp in late August	Yoruba	Elements under 2 Div AOR
Ondo	Lucky Aiyedatiwa (elected Nov 2024)	APC	Yoruba (Ilaje)	32 Artillery Bde (Akure/Owena)
Ekiti	Biodun Oyebanji	APC	Yoruba	Elements under 2 Div AOR (Ado-Ekiti garrison)

Changes to watch: a quiet week for the annex itself — no gubernatorial changes, no new GOC appointments, no operation re-designations. The substantive additions are corrective or CASEVAC-relevant: HQ 83 Division (Benin City) belonged in this table and was missing; 44 NARH Kaduna now has a commissioned helipad and critical care centre, which changes the North West casualty-receiving picture; and 28 Special Forces Brigade at FOB Sifawa is the formation that will own any Sokoto-axis request after the 26 August barracks attack. Watch items carried forward: the western corridor, where 29 Bde (Kainji) and 9 Div (Ilorin) are eight weeks old and Lakurawa's leadership is assessed to sit in Borgu; the Hong / Kopre Mountain axis in Adamawa under 23 Bde; a Rivers relapse (Fubara–Wike tension); and Operation Zenda in Benue, now taking public criticism that may constrain how it operates. Formation notes most relevant to the air mission are unchanged: 7 Div / OPHK (Maiduguri) is the supported command in the North East, with MNJTF ISR now visibly cueing strikes on the Lake Chad approaches; 8 Div (Sokoto) and 1 Div (Kaduna) run the North West

under Op Fansan Yamma; 3 Armoured Div (Jos) runs OPEP; NAF Tactical Air Command HQ is Makurdi, co-located with the new 5 Div HQ.

Reminder: This is open-source orientation only and is not a substitute for current in-theatre intelligence. Verify all specifics against your unit's authoritative reporting before acting on them operationally.